

GULF SOUTH FORGOTTEN HISTORY

Source-Documented Research Report

Smith Mercantile Company

Location: Covington, Louisiana

Period: 1890 - 1910

Research depth: Standard

Generated: September 01, 2026

Evidence-first research: OCR and automated analysis locate candidates; original records support findings.

1. Executive Summary

This report contains 1 saved finding(s), 2 discovered entity/entities, and 1 timeline event(s). 1 finding(s) are currently marked verified or corroborated.

Research question: Who operated the company and where was it located?

2. Research Scope

Subject	Smith Mercantile Company
Subject Type	Business / Organization
Geographic Focus	Covington, Louisiana
Date Range	1890 - 1910
Depth	Standard

3. Key Findings

1. 1898-06-17 - St. Tammany Farmer

Sample research finding showing Smith Mercantile Company operating on Columbia Street.

Status: Verified Source: <https://www.loc.gov/>

4. Chronological Timeline

Date	Event	Source
1898-06-17	Company advertised at Columbia Street.	St. Tammany Farmer

5. People, Businesses, Organizations & Places

Type	Name	Context	Confidence
Business / Organization	Smith Mercantile Company	Sample	Verified
Address	118 Columbia Street	Sample	Probable

6. Newspaper & Advertisement Findings

1898-06-17 - St. Tammany Farmer

Sample research finding showing Smith Mercantile Company operating on Columbia Street.

7. Business & Organization Findings

1898-06-17 - St. Tammany Farmer

Sample research finding showing Smith Mercantile Company operating on Columbia Street.

Research Gaps & Next Steps

- Ownership should be corroborated with a directory, property record, or legal notice.

Research Methodology

The research process begins with the strongest known identifiers, searches the most relevant sources first, extracts newly discovered names, organizations, addresses, dates and identifiers, and then uses those discoveries to make narrower follow-up searches. Duplicate results are suppressed, weak branches are not repeated, and important facts should be checked against the original source before being treated as established.

Source Search Log

Source	Query	Status
St. Tammany Farmer	Smith Mercantile	1 page hit(s)

Available Research Sources

Family	Source	Access
Newspapers	Library of Congress Chronicling America	Automatic
Archives	Historic New Orleans Collection	Open & search
Archives	Louisiana Digital Library / LSU	Open & search
Archives	Tulane digital collections	Open & search
Genealogy	U.S. Census / National Archives	Open & search
Genealogy	FamilySearch public collections	Open & search
Business	Louisiana Secretary of State Commercial Search	Open & search
Business	Louisiana licensing boards / contractor lookup	Open & search
Government	Louisiana Ethics Administration	Open & search
Government	Louisiana Legislative Auditor	Open & search
Government	Louisiana procurement / LaPAC	Open & search
Government	Local parish and municipal portals	Open & search
Government	USASpending.gov / SAM.gov	Open & search

Limitations

A source marked Open & search was not necessarily searched automatically. 'No online match' does not mean that no record exists. Some historical records remain undigitized, unindexed, restricted, or available only through a library, archive, courthouse, or records custodian. AI/OCR observations are research aids, not independent evidence.